4 WordPress Things I'd Tell Myself on Day One

14 years in. Still here.

The platform is more powerful than it looks.

Learn it before you go around it. Page builders and plugins solve problems — but only if you understand what problem you actually have first.

Child themes aren't optional.

If you care about updates — and you should — never customize a parent theme directly. You will lose your changes.

You don't need a plugin for everything.

Sometimes it's one filter hook and ten lines of code. Learn what WordPress can do natively before you reach for another plugin.

Own your hosting.

Never trade long-term control for short-term convenience.

14 years in — still on WordPress, still independent, still here.

Follow for more from someone who actually stayed.